

5 puzzles for a coffee break

Four numbers, three missing signs and one target. Take your time.

Use +, -, × or ÷. Keep the numbers in order. Work left to right.

Operators may repeat. Every division must give a whole number.

01

7		3		6		4
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TARGET

28

02

6		2		3		7
---	----------------------	---	----------------------	---	----------------------	---

TARGET

29

03

4		9		2		5
---	----------------------	---	----------------------	---	----------------------	---

TARGET

21

04

3		5		7		4
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TARGET

14

05

8		6		7		9
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TARGET

11

Keep the answers on the next page out of sight.

Ready for another set? Play free at

brainilabgames.com/games/number-route/



The routes, step by step

The running total is the key. Each route has exactly one valid solution.

Number Route uses a game-specific left-to-right rule.

For ordinary arithmetic, use the usual order of operations.

01 7, 3, 6, 4 → 28

$$7 - 3 = 4 \quad \text{then} \quad 4 \times 6 = 24 \quad \text{then} \quad 24 + 4 = 28$$

Signs: $-$, $\times$, $+$

02 6, 2, 3, 7 → 29

$$6 \times 2 = 12 \quad \text{then} \quad 12 \times 3 = 36 \quad \text{then} \quad 36 - 7 = 29$$

Signs: $\times$, $\times$, $-$

03 4, 9, 2, 5 → 21

$$4 + 9 = 13 \quad \text{then} \quad 13 \times 2 = 26 \quad \text{then} \quad 26 - 5 = 21$$

Signs: $+$, $\times$, $-$

04 3, 5, 7, 4 → 14

$$3 + 5 = 8 \quad \text{then} \quad 8 \times 7 = 56 \quad \text{then} \quad 56 \div 4 = 14$$

Signs: $+$, $\times$, $\div$

05 8, 6, 7, 9 → 11

$$8 + 6 = 14 \quad \text{then} \quad 14 \div 7 = 2 \quad \text{then} \quad 2 + 9 = 11$$

Signs: $+$, $\div$, $+$

A useful way to get unstuck

Look at the last number. Which total would you need just before it?

Then test a route forwards. Keep every number in its original place.